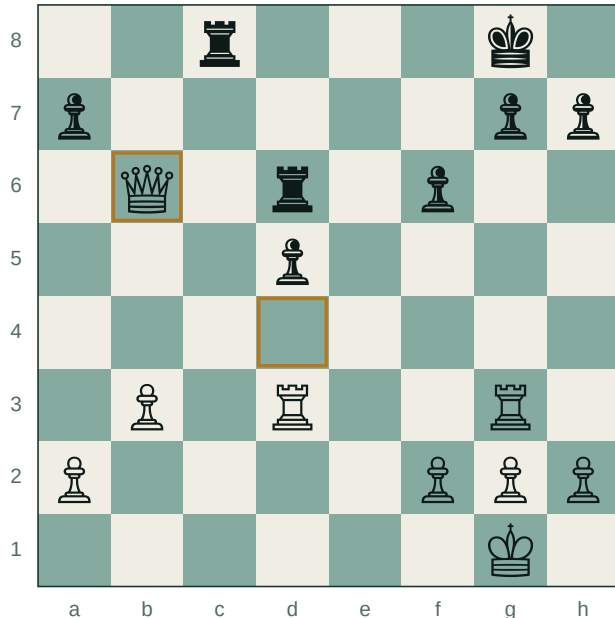


# Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 27

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Qxb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**27...Rc1+ 28. Rd1 Rxd1#**

**27...Rc1+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **28.Rd1**.

**28...Rxd1#** Mate: rook on d1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on d1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on b6. Check for tactical protection.